

Figure 2.9 *Taywara vicinity, Ghur Province, watch tower. From Herberg 1982: fig. 1.*

for plausible spans of occupation/use, or clues regarding the functions of the sites and structures. Nor does the fabric of the remains themselves, comprising walls primarily of unbaked brick (rarely baked) atop tall stone footings – as described above – provide diagnostics of date, as this construction method was prevalent in pre-Islamic strata throughout Afghanistan.[42] In the face of these challenges, it is worth interrogating – insofar as this is feasible, with parallel or illustrative data supporting the little direct evidence – whether the pre-imperial Shansabanis and other Ghuris of the eleventh century were indeed the fashioners of this landscape, as implied by Juzjani and generally accepted in modern scholarship. Would these groups' historical *habitus*, largely constituted of certain lifestyles and economies, have allowed or even called for the construction of numerous "dwelling towers," fortified enclosures, and other structures for defense and surveillance?